Instituto de Ciências Matemáticas e de Computação
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To the Editor-in-Chief
Multimedia Tools and Applications

Re: Submission of "Do Visual-Selection Operations Track Technical Quality? A Controlled Audit for Multi-Video Summarization"

Dear Editor,

We submit the manuscript above for consideration as a regular paper in *Multimedia Tools and Applications*.

Video summarization systems routinely score frames with operations borrowed from image quality work, and those scores are then read as evidence of technical fidelity. The manuscript asks whether they support that reading. We evaluate fifteen literature-derived operations from eleven source works on 800 original-versus-transformed comparisons and on 3 public image-quality databases, alongside attribute configurations and dedicated no-reference models, and we trace the consequence through to representative selection over 42 redundancy clusters. Every operation with a declared direction reverses on at least one transformation type, none meets both external screening conditions, and three of ten dedicated models do. One audited operation is decomposed to show the mechanism behind its behaviour rather than only its failure rate.

We believe the work fits the journal because it is an empirical audit of components that multimedia systems already deploy, not a proposal for a new scoring method. Its product is a screening protocol and a reusable set of controls, with every reported number emitted from released scripts.

One point of transparency, stated in the manuscript and repeated here. The modular summarization pipeline used as testbed and the broadcast corpus it runs on were both developed at our own laboratory, which is why we had access to the released code and to the material. Section 3.2 states this where the testbed is introduced, together with the reason the pipeline was chosen, namely that its quality criterion is a replaceable component. The audited visual-word operation is one of the works under study rather than a baseline of our own, and a negative result for it is not a failure of its source against its own stated objective, which was relevance and not technical fidelity. The full corpus remains with its authors and is not redistributed. The reproducibility archive contains scripts and derived data, plus a one-topic, three-video sample as described in the manuscript.

The manuscript is original, has not been published elsewhere, and is not under consideration by another journal. In the interest of transparency: an earlier submission of this work to another journal was returned at initial editorial screening, without peer review. Analysis scripts and machine-readable results accompany the submission as Online Resource 2, and the supplementary tables and figures are submitted as Online Resource 1.

We thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

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